

Glossary of Key Terms

Interface

A way a user interacts with a system or device.

Example: A mobile app screen or a computer desktop.

Command Line Interface (CLI)

A text-based interface where users type commands to perform tasks.

Example: Typing ls to list files.

Graphical User Interface (GUI)

An interface that uses visuals like windows, icons, and menus.

Example: Using a mouse to click icons on a desktop.

WIMP Interface

A type of GUI made of:

- **Windows**
- **Icons**
- **Menus**
- **Pointer**

Example: Traditional desktop computers.

Window

A section of the screen where an application or content is shown.

Example: A browser window or a document window.

Icon

A small image that represents an action or object.

Example: A trash bin icon for delete.

Menu

A list of options a user can choose from.

Example: A dropdown menu showing settings.

Dropdown Menu

A menu that opens to show more options when clicked.

Example: Selecting a country from a list.

Collapsible Menu

A menu that can expand or hide content.

Example: Clicking “+” to show more options.

Mega Menu

A large menu that shows many options at once in a structured layout.

Example: Navigation menus on large shopping websites.

Consistency

Keeping design elements the same across the interface.

Example: Using the same icons and colors on all pages.

Multimedia Interface

An interface that uses multiple media types like text, images, audio, and video.

Example: An educational app with videos and animations.

Virtual Reality (VR)

A computer-generated 3D environment that users can interact with.

Example: VR games where you feel inside the environment.

Presence (in VR)

The feeling of “being inside” a virtual environment.

Website Interface

A system of web pages designed for users to navigate and access information.

Breadcrumbs

Navigation links that show the user's path in a website.

Example: Home > Products > Shoes

Responsive Design

A design that adjusts layout based on screen size.

Example: A website that works on both phone and laptop.

Infinite Scrolling

A design where content loads continuously as the user scrolls.

Example: Social media feeds.

Mobile Interface

An interface designed for handheld devices.

Example: Smartphone apps.

Hit Area

The space a user taps on a screen to perform an action.

Example: A button on a phone screen.

QR Code

A scannable code that links to information or a website.

Example: Scanning a code to view a restaurant menu.

Appliance Interface

Interfaces of everyday devices used for simple tasks.

Example: Microwave or washing machine controls.

Affordance

Visual clues that show how something should be used.

Example: A button that looks clickable.

Feedback

A response from the system after a user action.

Example: A message saying "Form submitted."